SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

30 May 2022 · Shift 3

84 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 16 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 22 questions

Q.1

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. The South Indian dish was “approved by the guests” as it was tasty.

(A) accepted by the visitors
(B) gratified by the visitors
(C) doomed by the visitors
(D) condemned by the visitors

Q.2

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. She's been off work with _____ stomach.

(A) an upset
(B) an overset
(C) an agitated
(D) a perturbed

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Rohan is _____ self-sufficient man who needs no assistance.

(A) in
(B) a
(C) the
(D) of

Q.4

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Correspondence
(B) Campaign
(C) Experiment
(D) Accommadation

Q.6

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Suffice

(A) Excessed
(B) Immatured
(C) Satirize
(D) Dissatisfy

Q.7

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Opulence

(A) View
(B) Sagacity
(C) Recognition
(D) Prosperity

Q.8

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Back out

(A) To stand out
(B) To move backwards
(C) To withdraw from
(D) To pull over

Q.9

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Suchitra will have / to wait another month / before she received / any reply to her letter.

(A) any reply to her letter
(B) to wait another month
(C) Suchitra will have
(D) before she received

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. My mom told me “to have cleaning up” the kitchen before I go outside.

(A) to have clean out
(B) to clean up
(C) to clean over
(D) to clean out

Q.12

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. You are “so efficient as he”

(A) as efficient as him
(B) far efficient as he
(C) so efficient as him
(D) also efficient as he

Q.13

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Comparing apples with oranges

(A) Calculation of proteins
(B) Comparison between two kinds of fruits
(C) To have a health issue
(D) Unequal comparisons

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Their new house costed them _____ hundred and fifty-six thousand pounds.

(A) a
(B) the
(C) an
(D) few

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined word in the given sentence. The new software provides a perfect solution to the complex issues “pertaining” to pick up and delivery.

(A) Promoting
(B) Denying
(C) Trusting
(D) Referring

Q.16

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. Shrija “enquired about his daughter’s reputation.”

(A) assessed about his daughter’s strength
(B) condemned about his daughter’s well-being
(C) poked about his daughter’s role
(D) asked about his daughter’s character

Q.17

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A.In its most humble function, it is a necessary guide without which progress from place to place would be a ceaseless experiment; it is a sustenance without which organised society would be impossible, thus the Road moves and controls all history. B.The Road is one of the great fundamental institutions of mankind. C.It is the Road which controls the development of strategies and fixes the sites of battles. It is the Road that gives framework to all economic development. It is the Road which is the channel of all trade, and, what is more important, of all ideas. D.Not only is the Road one of the great human institutions because it is fundamental to social existence, but also because its varied effects appear in every department of the State. It is the Road which determines the sites of many cities and the growth and nourishment of all.

(A) BDCA
(B) DBAC
(C) CDAB
(D) ABCD

Q.18

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A sudden unsteady movement ; a stagger

(A) Lupin
(B) Lurch
(C) Lugger
(D) Lumen

Q.19

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. His poems are “recondite” in subject matter

(A) brief
(B) simple
(C) mystical
(D) obscure

Q.20

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word

(A) Absolute
(B) Abscent
(C) Absorb
(D) Abstract

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In everyday language, the phrase ‘sleepwalking’ can be used (1)_____ informally and symbolically to describe a lack of energy or attention. However, for (2)_____ infants and adults, sleepwalking is a genuine disorder with serious (3)_____. Sleepwalking, also known as somnambulism, is a sleep-related behaviour condition that causes people to walk or execute other (4)_____ acts while they are still partly sleeping. It is more (5)_____ in children than in adults, and it is more likely to develop if a person has a family history of the illness, is sleep deprived or has many nightly awakenings.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) neither
(B) like
(C) both
(D) to

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In everyday language, the phrase ‘sleepwalking’ can be used (1)_____ informally and symbolically to describe a lack of energy or attention. However, for (2)_____ infants and adults, sleepwalking is a genuine disorder with serious (3)_____. Sleepwalking, also known as somnambulism, is a sleep-related behaviour condition that causes people to walk or execute other (4)_____ acts while they are still partly sleeping. It is more (5)_____ in children than in adults, and it is more likely to develop if a person has a family history of the illness, is sleep deprived or has many nightly awakenings.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) impetus
(B) impulsions
(C) repercussions
(D) causes

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In everyday language, the phrase ‘sleepwalking’ can be used (1)_____ informally and symbolically to describe a lack of energy or attention. However, for (2)_____ infants and adults, sleepwalking is a genuine disorder with serious (3)_____. Sleepwalking, also known as somnambulism, is a sleep-related behaviour condition that causes people to walk or execute other (4)_____ acts while they are still partly sleeping. It is more (5)_____ in children than in adults, and it is more likely to develop if a person has a family history of the illness, is sleep deprived or has many nightly awakenings.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) comprehensive
(B) complicated
(C) compound
(D) combined

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In everyday language, the phrase ‘sleepwalking’ can be used (1)_____ informally and symbolically to describe a lack of energy or attention. However, for (2)_____ infants and adults, sleepwalking is a genuine disorder with serious (3)_____. Sleepwalking, also known as somnambulism, is a sleep-related behaviour condition that causes people to walk or execute other (4)_____ acts while they are still partly sleeping. It is more (5)_____ in children than in adults, and it is more likely to develop if a person has a family history of the illness, is sleep deprived or has many nightly awakenings.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) triumphant
(B) prevalent
(C) swift
(D) hidden

General Intelligence 18 questions

Q.1

In a certain code language, 'CHILD' is written as ‘6169248' and 'GUEST' is written as '142153840'. How will 'BOOK' be written in that language?

(A) 2303011
(B) 41522
(C) 4151522
(D) 23011

Q.2

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 4 : 80 :: 7 : 392 :: 5 : ?

(A) 148
(B) 136
(C) 162
(D) 150

Q.3

Which of the following letter-clusters will replace the question mark (?) in the given series to make it logically complete? YXZ, VUW, SRT, POQ, ?

(A) LMN
(B) MLN
(C) NML
(D) LNM

Q.5

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 4, 8, 5, ?, 15, 90

(A) 18
(B) 13
(C) 22
(D) 20

Q.6

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. GREATLY : ERGAYLT :: MIXTURE : XIMTERU :: TROUBLE : ?

(A) BORTUEL
(B) ORTUEBL
(C) TUELBOR
(D) ORTUELB

Q.8

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? NHMS, HNOU, ?, HNSY, NHUA

(A) HNOX
(B) NHSX
(C) HNPY
(D) NHQW

Q.9

Three Statements are given followed by Three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All towels are cloths. No cloth is a blanket. Some blankets are cushions. Conclusions: I. Some towels are cushions. II. No cushion is a cloth. III. No towel is a blanket.

(A) Only conclusion III follows.
(B) Only conclusion I follows.
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(D) Both conclusions I and III follow.

Q.11

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 43*11*4*71*16

(A) −,=,+,×
(B) =,−,+,×
(C) +,×,=,+
(D) −,×,=,+

Q.12

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 57*35*7*14*2*80

(A) −,÷,+,×, =
(B) ×, +, ÷,−, =
(C) +,−, ×,÷, =
(D) +, −, ÷,×, =

Q.13

The second number in the given number-pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number-pairs EXCEPT one. Find that odd number-pair.

(A) 16 : 8
(B) 4 : 5
(C) 9 : 6
(D) 36 : 9

Q.14

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1.Resolve 2.Rodent 3.Resonant 4.Return 5.Respond 6.Rigidity

(A) 1, 3, 5, 4, 2, 6
(B) 3, 1, 5, 4, 2, 6
(C) 1, 3, 5, 4, 6, 2
(D) 1, 3, 4, 5, 6, 2

Q.16

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs except one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 53 : 2916
(B) 41 : 1765
(C) 23 : 576
(D) 19 : 400

Q.18

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 13, 25, 38, 62, 88, 124, 163, 211, ?

(A) 253
(B) 263
(C) 235
(D) 236

Q.19

Select the option that is related to the fourth term in the same way as the first term is related to the second term and the fifth term is related to the sixth term 7 : 58 :: ? : 370 :: 12 : 153

(A) 20
(B) 18
(C) 21
(D) 19

Q.20

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and fourth term related to third term. 13 : 130 :: 15 : 180 :: 27 : ?

(A) 649
(B) 658
(C) 650
(D) 648

Q.21

Select the option that is related to the fourth term in the same way as the first term is related to the second term and the fifth term is related to the sixth term 64 : 320 :: ? : 70 :: 22 : 110

(A) 12
(B) 14
(C) 8
(D) 17

Q.22

In a certain code language, 'RAIN' is written as 'MHZQ' and ‘COAT’ is written as ‘SZNB’. How will 'ROLE' be written in that language?

(A) DKNQ
(B) QDKN
(C) KQDN
(D) NDKQ

Q.23

In a certain code language, 'SITAR' is written as 'RHSZQ' and ‘BANJO’ is written as ‘AZMIN’. How will 'TABLA' be written in that language?

(A) SAZKZ
(B) SZAKZ
(C) SZKAZ
(D) SZAZA

Quantitative Aptitude 20 questions

Q.2

The average runs scored by Sunil in 17 innings is 37. What is his score in the 17th inning, thereby, increasing his average score by 9 runs?

(A) 81
(B) 108
(C) 181
(D) 167

Q.3

In a company, there are only two types of employees: workers and officers. The average monthly salary of an officer is ₹78,000 more than the combined average monthly salary of an employee, while the combined average monthly salary of an employee is ₹42,000 more than the average monthly salary of a worker. What percentage of all the employees are officers?

(A) 28%
(B) 35%
(C) 30%
(D) 32%

Q.5

What is the volume of a right circular cylinder whose curved surface area is 12 π cm^2 and the circumference of its base is 4 π cm?

(A) 48π cm^3
(B) 36π cm^3
(C) 12π cm^3
(D) 24π cm^3

Q.6

The curved surface area of a right circular cone of radius 28 cm is 4664 cm^2. What is the slant height of the cone?(Use π=22/7)

(A) 53 cm
(B) 56 cm
(C) 64 cm
(D) 48 cm

Q.7

The number 36 is increased by a certain percentage and becomes 63. Calculate that percentage.

(A) 50%
(B) 75%
(C) 60%
(D) 85%

Q.8

Find the third proportion to 16 and 24.

(A) 30
(B) 32
(C) 36
(D) 42

Q.9

If $a + b = 25$, then $(a - 15)^3 + (b - 10)^3$ is:

(A) 125
(B) 0
(C) 625
(D) 225

Q.10

If $p^3 + 3p^2 + 3p = 26$, then the value of $p^2 + 2p$ is:

(A) 8 **(B)** 12

(C) 10 **(D)** 15

Q.11

In a triangle ABC, CA is produced to P, $\angle BAP=126°$. If $\angle B : \angle C = 5 : 2$, the degree measures of $\angle B$ and $\angle C$ are respectively:

(A) 90° and 36° **(B)** 84° and 42°

(C) 78° and 48° **(D)** 70° and 56°

Q.12

When the price of a watch was reduced by 20%, the number of watches sold is increased by 40%. What was the effect on the sales in percentage?

(A) 12% increase **(B)** 30% decrease

(C) 12% decrease **(D)** 30% increase

Q.16

Simplify the following : $6 \times \{6 \text{ of } (6 + 6)\} \div \{(6 \div 6) \times (600\% \text{ of } 6)\}$

(A) 12 **(B)** 15552

(C) 108 **(D)** 6

Q.17

A book is sold for ₹1,554 by allowing a discount of 26% on its marked price. Find the marked price of the book.

(A) ₹1,854 **(B)** ₹2,100

(C) ₹1,750 **(D)** ₹2,000

Q.18

Malay walks around a circular field at the rate of 7 rounds per hour,while Neha runs around it at the rate of 11 rounds per hour. They start in the same direction from the same point at 02:45 p.m. They shall first cross each other at:

(A) 03:00 p.m. **(B)** 03:05 p.m.

(C) 02:50 p.m. **(D)** 03:00 a.m.

Q.19

A can do a piece of work alone in 96 days and B can do it alone in 104 days. In how many days can the duo, working together, complete the work?

(A) 49.94 **(B)** 49.92

(C) 49.96 **(D)** 49.88

Q.20

The Earth makes a complete rotation about its axis in 24 hours. Through what angle will it turn in 3 hours 30 minutes?

(A) 60° **(B)** 65°

(C) 50° **(D)** 52.5°

Q.21

What is the compound interest on ₹20,000 for 9 months at the rate of 4% per annum, when interest is compounded quarterly?

(A) ₹610 **(B)** ₹606.02

(C) ₹609.05 **(D)** ₹605

Q.22

The marked price of a shirt is ₹2,150. Let two successive discounts offered by the store be 10% and 'x%'. If the selling price of the shirt is ₹1,505, then calculate the value of 'x'. [Give your answer correct to two decimal places.]

(A) 24.44%
(B) 24.24%
(C) 22.22%
(D) 22.42%

Q.23

Romesh opened a fixed deposits account in his bank for 3 years by depositing ₹80,000.The bank has promised to pay him compound interest annually at the rate of 7% per annum. What is the maturity value of his FDR? (Nearest to a ₹)

(A) ₹98,003
(B) ₹98,970
(C) ₹98,010
(D) ₹98,900

Q.24

If the number 5X8146Y is divisible by 88, then what is the value of X?

(A) 3
(B) 1
(C) 2
(D) 4

Q.25

A man bought a piece of land for ₹48,000. He sold two-fifth of it at a loss of 10%. At what gain percentage (rounded off to 1 decimal place) should he sell the remaining land to earn an overall profit of 42%?

(A) 76.7%
(B) 84.3%
(C) 79.5%
(D) 89.8%

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Ustad Bade Ghulam Ali Khan is also known as _____.

(A) Sitar maestro
(B) Alla Rakha
(C) the Bharat Ratna recipient
(D) Tansen of the 20th century

Q.2

In which track and field event is the hop used?

(A) Javelin throw
(B) High jump
(C) Triple jump
(D) Broad jump

Q.3

In December 2021, who among the following inaugurated the 'Bharat Darshan Park' in Delhi, which has replicas of major monuments from across the country created by a group of artists?

(A) Amit Shah
(B) Dharmendra Pradhan
(C) Nirmala Sitharaman
(D) Smriti Irani

Q.4

Which of the following books is an autobiography of the Indian novelist Khushwant Singh?

(A) My Confession
(B) Truth, Love & A Little Malice
(C) My Story
(D) My Autobiography

Q.5

A batsman can be given out in_____ ways.

(A) 6
(B) 8
(C) 10
(D) 5

Q.6
The Sangeet Natak Akademi is a body working under which of the following ministries of the Government of India?

(A) Ministry of Education
(B) Ministry of Home Affairs
(C) Ministry of Culture
(D) Ministry of Tourism

Q.7
In cell biology, what is a large double-membraned organelle that is sometimes referred to as the 'central unit' of the cell because it contains the chromosomes that bear genetic material?

(A) Peroxisome
(B) Nucleus
(C) Mitochondrion
(D) Lysosome

Q.9
Lemon juice contains _____ which when mixed with baking soda reacts to form carbon dioxide and sodium citrate causing the liquid to fizz and bubble.

(A) acetic acid
(B) formic acid
(C) citric acid
(D) tartaric acid

Q.10
Rukmini Devi Arundale, awarded with Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1957, was a _____ dancer.

(A) Bharatanatyam
(B) Manipuri
(C) Kathak
(D) Kathakali

Q.11
'The Private life of an Indian Prince' is a novel written by whom among the following authors?

(A) Mulk Raj Anand
(B) Ruskin Bond
(C) R K Narayanan
(D) Arvind Adiga

Q.12
The valleys lying between the lesser Himalayas and Shivaliks are called:

(A) Duars
(B) Tehri
(C) Terai
(D) Duns

Q.13
When was the Lalit Kala Akademi established?

(A) 1965
(B) 1956
(C) 1951
(D) 1954

Q.14
The micro finance movement in India was formally launched on a pilot basis by the _____in _____.

(A) National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD); 1992
(B) National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD); 1994
(C) Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI); 1994
(D) Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI); 1992

Q.15
When do electrons move for the flow of charges in a conducting metallic wire?

(A) When there is no difference of electric pressure
(B) When the charges stop flowing
(C) Only if there is a difference of electric pressure
(D) Due to gravity

Q.16
A Minister who for any period of _____ is not a member of either House of Parliament shall at the expiration of that period cease to be a Minister.

(A) six consecutive months
(B) three consecutive months
(C) four consecutive months
(D) eight consecutive months

Q.17
A balanced diet takes care of all the following aspects, EXCEPT one. Identify the aspect.

(A) Promotes a healthy mind
(B) Meets the RDA for all nutrients
(C) Includes nutrients in correct proportions
(D) Includes a variety of food items

Q.18
Which of the following novels was written by the Indian author Anuradha Roy?

(A) Tell Her Everything
(B) Sleeping on Jupiter
(C) Midnight's Children
(D) The Illicit Happiness of Other People

Q.19
Which state of India launched the 'Ashirbad' scheme for education, health and maintenance of Covid orphans in June 2021?

(A) Karnataka
(B) Kerala
(C) Maharashtra
(D) Odisha

Q.20
As per statistics published by National Crime Records Bureau for 2020, which state tops in total number of crime incidences against senior citizens (60 years and above)?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Bihar
(D) Uttar Pradesh

Q.21
Ustad Bismillah Khan is best known for playing which of the following instruments?

(A) Tambura
(B) Sitar
(C) Sarod
(D) Shehnai

Q.22
Sangeet Natak Akademi Award was constituted in which of the following years?

(A) 1969
(B) 1947
(C) 1952
(D) 1961

Q.23
Pandit Ananda Gopal Bandopadhyay was a _____ player of the Banaras gharana.

(A) sarangi
(B) sarod
(C) sitar
(D) tabla

Q.24
How is food stored in brown algae?

(A) In the form of glucose
(B) In the form of complex carbohydrates that may be in the form of laminarin or mannitol
(C) In the form of complex lipids
(D) In the form of oil droplets

Q.25

Who among the following is credited with building Delhi's Lāl Quilā (Red Fort)?

(A) Akbar

(B) Jahangir

(C) Sher Shah Suri

(D) Shah Jahan

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(D)**
Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(A)**
Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**
Q.21 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(B)**		

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.9 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**
Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**
Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**
Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**
Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(A)**				

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (A) accepted by the visitors

SSC's key gives 'accepted by the visitors', the only option that keeps the sense of 'approved by the guests': a dish is not 'gratified', and 'doomed' and 'condemned' contradict 'tasty'. The original wording is itself acceptable, but no 'no improvement' option is offered.

Q.2 · Answer (A) an upset

'An upset stomach' is the usual phrase for a stomach disorder.

Q.3 · Answer (B) a

'Self-sufficient' begins with a consonant sound, and the man is not one already identified: 'a self-sufficient man'.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Accommadation

The correct spelling is 'accommodation', with a double 'c' and a double 'm'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Dissatisfy

To 'suffice' is to be enough, to satisfy a need; its opposite among the options is 'dissatisfy'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Prosperity

'Opulence' is great wealth or luxury: 'prosperity'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) To withdraw from

To 'back out' of something is to withdraw from a promise or arrangement.

Q.9 · Answer (D) before she received

The main clause is in the future ('will have to wait'), so the time clause takes the simple present: 'before she receives'.

Q.10 · Answer (B) to clean up

'Tell someone to' is followed by the base form of the verb, and 'clean up' (make tidy) keeps the original meaning: 'told me to clean up the kitchen'. To 'clean out' is to empty something, such as a cupboard.

Q.12 · Answer (A) as efficient as him

An affirmative comparison takes 'as … as'; 'so … as' is used mainly after a negative. 'As efficient as him' is the only option with 'as … as' (formal English also has 'as efficient as he').

Q.13 · Answer (D) Unequal comparisons

'Comparing apples with oranges' is comparing two things too different to be fairly compared.

Q.14 · Answer (A) a

'A hundred' means one hundred: 'a hundred and fifty-six thousand pounds'.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Referring

'Pertaining to' means relating or referring to.

Q.16 · Answer (D) asked about his daughter’s character

SSC's key gives 'asked about his daughter's character': 'enquired about' means 'asked about', and character is close to reputation. One does not 'assess about', 'condemn about' or 'poke about' something in this sense; the original wording is itself acceptable.

Q.17 · Answer (A) BDCA

B introduces the Road as a fundamental institution, D explains why it is one, C lists what it controls, and A ends with the conclusion 'thus the Road moves and controls all history': BDCA.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Lurch

To 'lurch' is to make a sudden unsteady movement, to stagger. A lupin is a plant, a lugger a small sailing boat and a lumen a unit of light.

Q.19 · Answer (B) simple
'Recondite' means obscure, known only to a few; its opposite is 'simple'.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Abscent
The correct spelling is 'absent'.

Q.21 · Answer (C) both
'Both informally and symbolically': 'both' pairs with 'and' to join the two adverbs.

Q.23 · Answer (C) repercussions
A genuine disorder has serious 'repercussions', that is consequences; 'impetus', 'impulsions' and 'causes' do not fit.

Q.24 · Answer (B) complicated
Sleepwalkers walk or carry out other 'complicated' acts while still partly asleep.

Q.25 · Answer (B) prevalent
It is more 'prevalent', that is more common, in children than in adults.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (C) 4151522
Consonants are written as twice their alphabet positions and vowels as their positions: C, H, I, L, D → 6, 16, 9, 24, 8 and G, U, E, S, T → 14, 21, 5, 38, 40. So B, O, O, K → 4, 15, 15, 22: 4151522.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 150
Each second number is the square of the first times one more than it: $4^2 \times 5 = 80$ and $7^2 \times 8 = 392$. So $5^2 \times 6 = 150$.

Q.3 · Answer (B) MLN
Each letter moves 3 places back: Y, V, S, P, M; X, U, R, O, L; Z, W, T, Q, N. The next cluster is MLN.

Q.5 · Answer (D) 20
The operations alternate × 2, – 3, × 4, – 5, × 6: 4 × 2 = 8, 8 – 3 = 5, 5 × 4 = 20, 20 – 5 = 15 and 15 × 6 = 90.

Q.6 · Answer (D) ORTUELB
The first three letters are reversed, the middle letter stays and the last three are reversed: GRE A TLY → ERG A YLT and MIX T URE → XIM T ERU. So TRO U BLE → ORT U ELB: ORTUELB.

Q.8 · Answer (D) NHQW
The first two letters alternate NH, HN, NH, HN, NH; the third letters move 2 places forward (M, O, Q, S, U) and so do the fourth (S, U, W, Y, A). The missing cluster is NHQW.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Only conclusion III follows.
All towels are cloths and no cloth is a blanket, so no towel is a blanket (III). Nothing links towels or cloths to cushions with certainty, so I and II do not follow.

Q.11 · Answer (C) +,×,=,+
With +, ×, = and +: 43 + 11 × 4 = 43 + 44 = 87, and 71 + 16 = 87.

Q.12 · Answer (A) –,÷,+,×, =
With –, ÷, +, × and =: 57 – 35 ÷ 7 + 14 × 2 = 57 – 5 + 28 = 80.

Q.13 · Answer (A) 16 : 8
In 4 : 5, 9 : 6 and 36 : 9 the second number is the square root of the first plus 3 (2 + 3, 3 + 3, 6 + 3). For 16 it would be 4 + 3 = 7, not 8, so 16 : 8 is the odd pair.

Q.14 · Answer (C) 1, 3, 5, 4, 6, 2
In dictionary order: Resolve (1), Resonant (3), Respond (5), Return (4), Rigidity (6), Rodent (2). 'Resol' comes before 'Reson', and both before 'Resp'.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 41 : 1765
In 53 : 2916, 23 : 576 and 19 : 400 the second number is the square of one more than the first (54^2, 24^2, 20^2). $42^2 = 1764$, not 1765, so 41 : 1765 is the odd pair.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 263
The differences are 12, 13, 24, 26, 36, 39, 48: multiples of 12 and of 13 in turn. The next difference is $4 \times 13 = 52$: $211 + 52 = 263$.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 19
Each second number is the square of the first plus 9: $7^2 + 9 = 58$ and $12^2 + 9 = 153$. $370 - 9 = 361 = 19^2$, so the missing number is 19.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 648
Each number is multiplied by 3 less than itself: $13 \times 10 = 130$ and $15 \times 12 = 180$. So $27 \times 24 = 648$.

Q.21 · Answer (B) 14
The second number is five times the first: $64 \times 5 = 320$ and $22 \times 5 = 110$. So $70 \div 5 = 14$.

Q.22 · Answer (A) DKNQ
The word is written in reverse and each letter moves one place back: RAIN → NIAR → MHZQ and COAT → TAOC → SZNB. So ROLE → ELOR → DKNQ.

Q.23 · Answer (B) SZAKZ
Each letter moves one place back: SITAR → RHSZQ and BANJO → AZMIN. So TABLA → SZAKZ.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 · Answer (C) 181
After 17 innings the total is $17 \times 37 = 629$. Before the 17th inning the average was $37 - 9 = 28$, a total of $16 \times 28 = 448$. The 17th inning scored $629 - 448 = 181$.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 35%
Let officers be a fraction f of the staff and the overall average A. Officers average A + 78,000 and workers A – 42,000, so $78{,}000f = 42{,}000(1 - f)$: $1{,}20{,}000f = 42{,}000$ and $f = 0.35$, that is 35%.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 12π cm^3
$2\pi r = 4\pi$ gives $r = 2$ cm, and $2\pi rh = 12\pi$ gives $h = 3$ cm. $V = \pi r^2 h = \pi \times 4 \times 3 = 12\pi$ cm^3.

Q.6 · Answer (A) 53 cm
Curved surface area = πrl: $(22/7) \times 28 \times l = 88l = 4664$, so $l = 53$ cm.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 75%
The increase is $63 - 36 = 27$, and $27/36 \times 100 = 75\%$.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 36
If $16 : 24 = 24 : x$, then $x = 24^2/16 = 576/16 = 36$.

Q.9 · Answer (B) 0
$(a - 15) + (b - 10) = a + b - 25 = 0$. When $x + y = 0$, $x^3 + y^3 = (x + y)(x^2 - xy + y^2) = 0$.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 8
Adding 1 to both sides: $p^3 + 3p^2 + 3p + 1 = (p + 1)^3 = 27$, so $p = 2$. Then $p^2 + 2p = 4 + 4 = 8$.

Q.11 · Answer (A) 90° and 36°
The exterior angle ∠BAP equals the sum of the interior opposite angles: $\angle B + \angle C = 126°$. In the ratio 5 : 2, $\angle B = 90°$ and $\angle C = 36°$.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 12% increase
Sales value = price × number sold: $0.8 \times 1.4 = 1.12$, a 12% increase.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 12
6 of (6 + 6) = 72 and 600% of 6 = 36, so the expression is $6 \times 72 \div (1 \times 36) = 432 \div 36 = 12$.

Q.17 · Answer (B) ₹2,100
After a 26% discount the selling price is 74% of the marked price: 1,554/0.74 = ₹2,100.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 03:00 p.m.
Going the same way, Neha gains 11 − 7 = 4 rounds an hour on Malay, so she first passes him after 1/4 hour, 15 minutes: at 03:00 p.m.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 49.92
Together they take (96 × 104)/(96 + 104) = 9,984/200 = 49.92 days.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 52.5°
The Earth turns 360° in 24 hours, 15° an hour. In 3.5 hours it turns 3.5 × 15° = 52.5°.

Q.21 · Answer (B) ₹606.02
Compounded quarterly at 1% for 3 quarters: 20,000 × (1.01^3 − 1) = 20,000 × 0.030301 = ₹606.02.

Q.22 · Answer (C) 22.22%
After 10% off, 2,150 × 0.9 = ₹1,935. The second discount takes it to ₹1,505: x = 430/1,935 × 100 = 22.22%.

Q.23 · Answer (A) ₹98,003
80,000 × 1.07^3 = 80,000 × 1.225043 = ₹98,003.44, which is ₹98,003 to the nearest rupee.

Q.24 · Answer (A) 3
88 = 8 × 11. For 8, the last three digits 46Y must be divisible by 8, so Y = 4 (464). For 11, (5 + 8 + 4 + 4) − (X + 1 + 6) = 14 − X must be a multiple of 11, so X = 3.

Q.25 · Answer (A) 76.7%
Two-fifths cost ₹19,200 and sold for ₹17,280. For a 42% profit the whole must fetch ₹68,160, so the remaining three-fifths (cost ₹28,800) must sell for ₹50,880: a gain of 22,080/28,800 = 76.7%.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Tansen of the 20th century
Ustad Bade Ghulam Ali Khan, the Patiala gharana vocalist, is often called the 'Tansen of the 20th century'. He was a singer, not a sitarist, and received the Padma Bhushan, not the Bharat Ratna; Alla Rakha was a tabla player.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Triple jump
The triple jump is a hop, a step and a jump in sequence.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Amit Shah
Union Home Minister Amit Shah opened the Bharat Darshan Park, built by the South Delhi Municipal Corporation with replicas made largely from scrap, in late December 2021.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Truth, Love & A Little Malice
Khushwant Singh's autobiography is 'Truth, Love & A Little Malice' (2002).

Q.5 · Answer (C) 10
Traditionally a batsman can be out in ten ways: bowled, caught, leg before wicket, stumped, run out, hit wicket, handled the ball, hit the ball twice, obstructing the field and timed out. (Since 2017 the Laws count handling the ball as obstructing the field, leaving nine, which is not an option.)

Q.6 · Answer (C) Ministry of Culture
The Sangeet Natak Akademi, the national academy of music, dance and drama, is an autonomous body under the Ministry of Culture.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Nucleus
The nucleus, enclosed by a double membrane (the nuclear envelope), holds the chromosomes and controls the cell's activities.

Q.9 · Answer (C) citric acid
Lemon juice contains citric acid, which reacts with baking soda (sodium hydrogencarbonate) to give carbon dioxide, sodium citrate and water.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Bharatanatyam
Rukmini Devi Arundale, who founded Kalakshetra in Madras in 1936, was a Bharatanatyam dancer who led the revival of the form.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Mulk Raj Anand
'The Private Life of an Indian Prince' (1953) is a novel by Mulk Raj Anand.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Duns
NCERT calls the longitudinal valleys between the Lesser Himalaya and the Shiwaliks 'duns': Dehra Dun, Kotli Dun and Patli Dun among them.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 1954
The Lalit Kala Akademi, the national academy of the visual arts, was set up in 1954.

Q.14 · Answer (A) National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD); 1992
NABARD launched the Self-Help Group-Bank Linkage Programme as a pilot in 1992, aiming to link 500 self-help groups with banks.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Only if there is a difference of electric pressure
Electrons flow along a conductor only when there is a potential difference, the 'difference of electric pressure', across it, such as a cell provides.

Q.16 · Answer (A) six consecutive months
Under Article 75(5) a Minister who is not a member of either House for six consecutive months ceases to be a Minister at the end of that period.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Promotes a healthy mind
SSC's key gives 'Promotes a healthy mind': the other three describe what a balanced diet is, a variety of foods supplying every nutrient in the right proportions to meet the recommended dietary allowance (RDA). Good nutrition does also help the mind, so the key rests on that definition.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Sleeping on Jupiter
Anuradha Roy wrote 'Sleeping on Jupiter' (2015), which won the DSC Prize for South Asian Literature. 'Midnight's Children' is Salman Rushdie's and 'The Illicit Happiness of Other People' Manu Joseph's.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Odisha
Odisha launched 'Ashirbad' on 20 June 2021 for children who had lost one or both parents, or the family's earning member, to Covid-19.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Maharashtra
SSC's key gives Maharashtra as the state with the most cases of crime against senior citizens in NCRB's 'Crime in India 2020'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Shehnai
Ustad Bismillah Khan, Bharat Ratna (2001), was the great master of the shehnai.

Q.22 · Answer (C) 1952
The Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (Akademi Puraskar) was instituted in 1952, the year the Akademi was set up.

Q.23 · Answer (D) tabla
Pandit Ananda Gopal Bandopadhyay was a tabla player trained in the style of the Banaras gharana.

Q.24 · Answer (B) In the form of complex carbohydrates that may be in the form of laminarin or mannitol
In brown algae (Phaeophyceae) food is stored as complex carbohydrates, laminarin or mannitol.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Shah Jahan

Shah Jahan built the Red Fort between 1639 and 1648 as the palace of his new capital, Shahjahanabad.

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